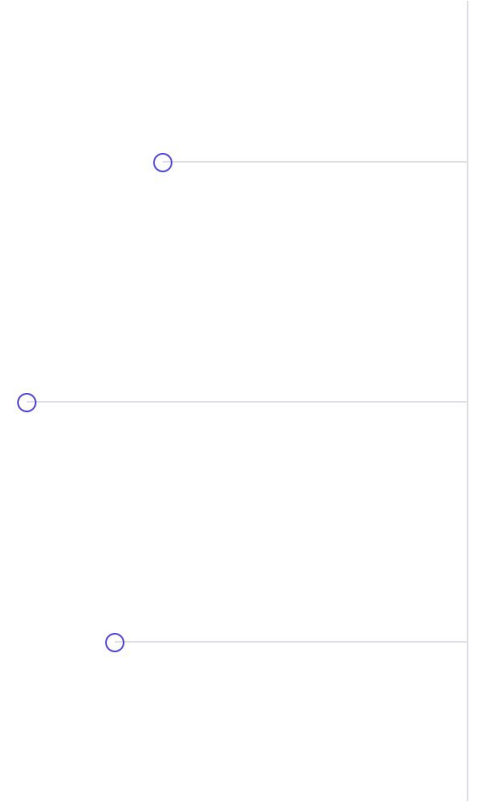


DDX / A 60-minute workshop

THE DESIGN GENOME

Building design systems for humans
and the AI era.



The person guiding the room

Ivan Barriga

Head of Product Design & UX

Design systems AI-assisted creation Product design Design leadership

Exploring how organizational design intelligence survives the tools creating the interface.

AI makes creating UI
nearly free.

It also makes creating
inconsistent UI nearly free.

Who creates now?

Designer

PM

Prototyping tool

Engineer

AI coding tool

Agent



Product /
interface

Consistency can no longer depend on every creator remembering everything the organization knows.

The Button



Delete project

When is destructive treatment appropriate?

Does this require confirmation?

What should the confirmation explain?

What should the action be called?

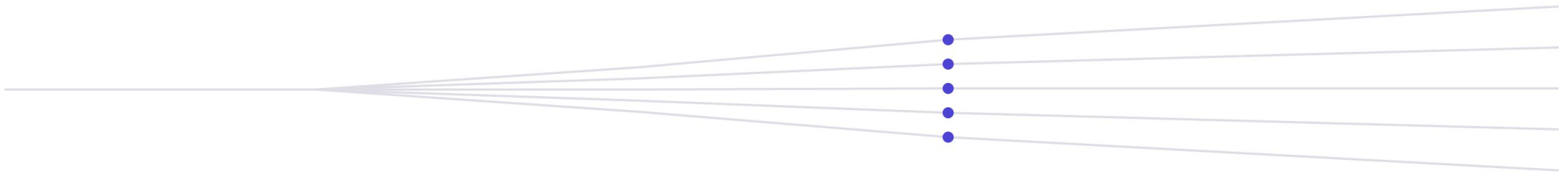
Who can approve an exception?

A component can tell us what exists.

It doesn't necessarily carry every decision surrounding its use.

Most drift isn't irrational.

Products drift through hundreds of individually reasonable decisions.



Organizational design intelligence

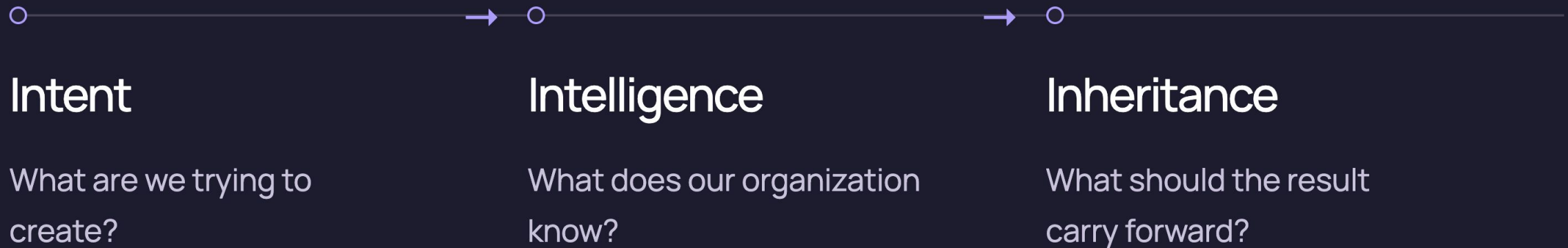
What if the system carried the knowledge forward?

Not another AI tool.

Design Genome is a methodology for structuring an organization's design intelligence so humans and AI can create from the same governed system.

Additive to your existing system. Human-facing experiences remain first-class.

Design knowledge, carried forward.



Human or machine objective → organizational design intelligence → a result that inherits design decisions.

Fewer guesses.

Without organizational intelligence

Intent



Documentation + memory + assumptions



Reasonable guesses

The goal isn't to make AI the designer.

It's to make organizational knowledge available when something gets created.

With Design Genome

Intent



Relevant organizational intelligence



Fewer organizational decisions are guesses

Experience it

Same task. More knowledge to work from.

Experience it →

Delete project · Create project · Analytics



design-genome.com/workshop

Four complementary capabilities.

Governance crosses every capability

**Design
Intelligence**

Human-readable

Machine-readable

Executable

Connectable

Capabilities, not sequential maturity levels.

What is in a Genome?

Principles

Foundations

Components

Patterns

Content

Rules

Governance

Different knowledge. Appropriate representations.
[Connected authority.](#)

These sources do not need to live in one file.

The reference implementation

FORMA

A fictional product used
to test the methodology.

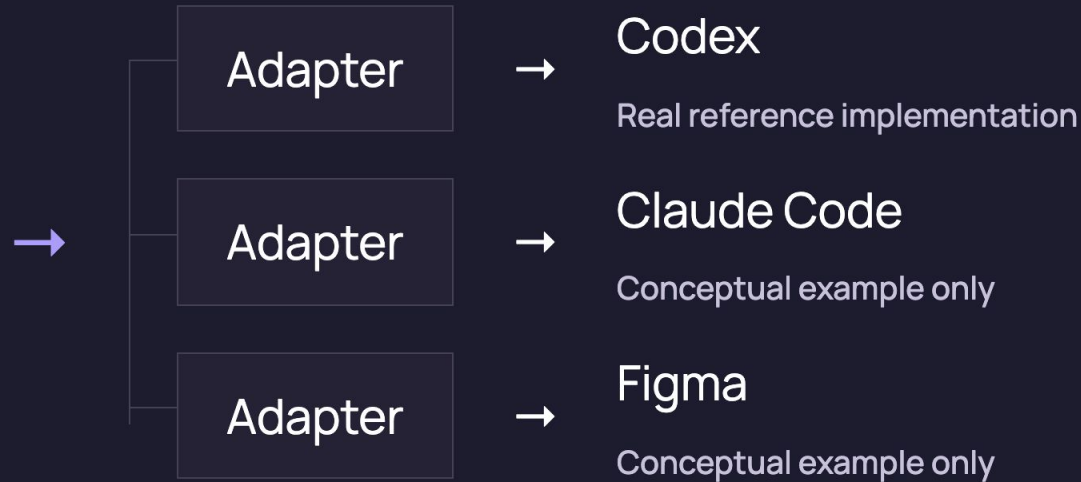
One implementation.
Not the methodology itself.

```
genome/  
├─ principles/  
├─ foundations/  
├─ components/  
├─ patterns/  
├─ content/  
├─ rules/  
└─ governance/
```

The adapter

Design Genome

Organizational knowledge



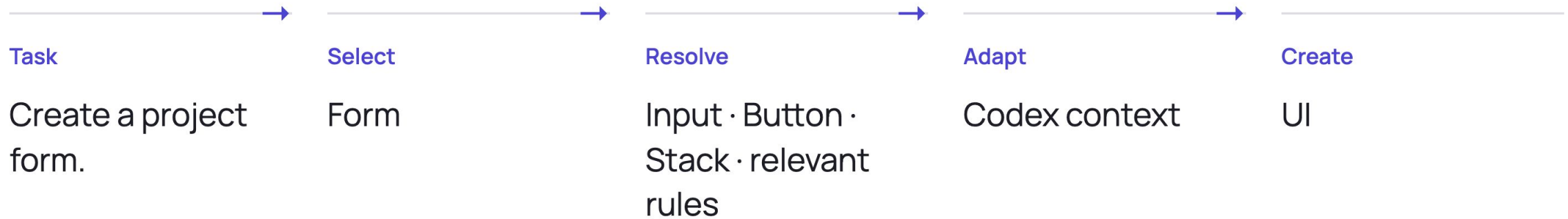
An adapter translates relevant Design Genome knowledge into a form a particular consumer can use.

The adapter doesn't own the knowledge. Validation and enforcement remain separate.

The AI tool is replaceable.

Your organization's design intelligence isn't.

From a task to relevant intelligence.



Supplied context does not certify the result. Implementation still needs judgment and review.

[Inspect real machine context →](#) [Open executable Forma showcase ↗](#)

The showcase opens separately. The deck stays here.

Your turn

Enough about Forma.
Think about your organization.

Build your first Gene.

You don't start by building a Genome.
You start by encoding one decision worth inheriting.

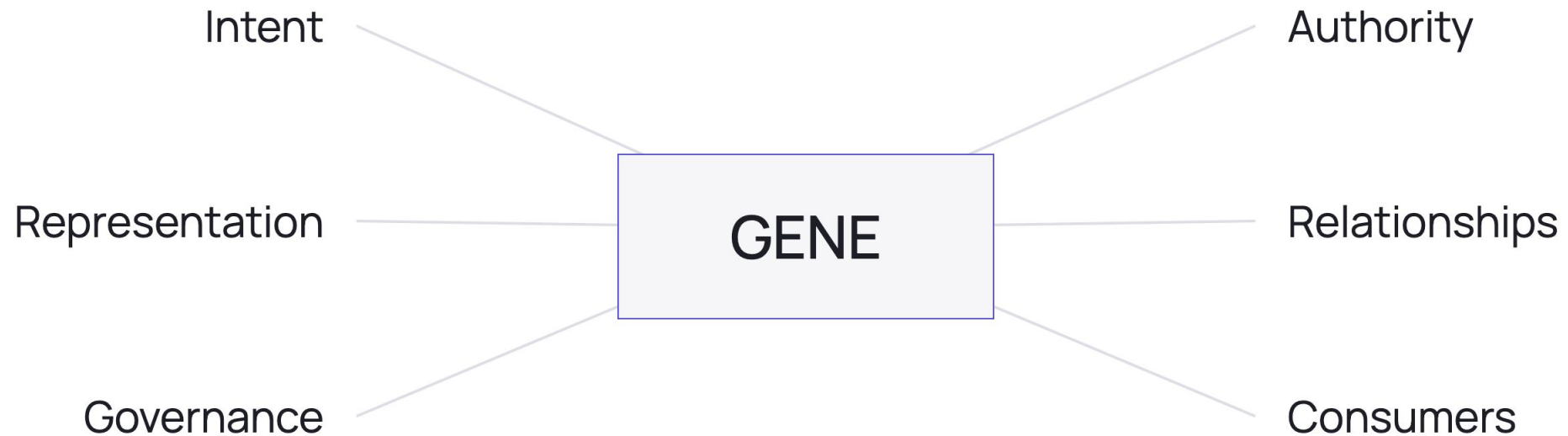
Build your first Gene →



design-genome.com/build/gene

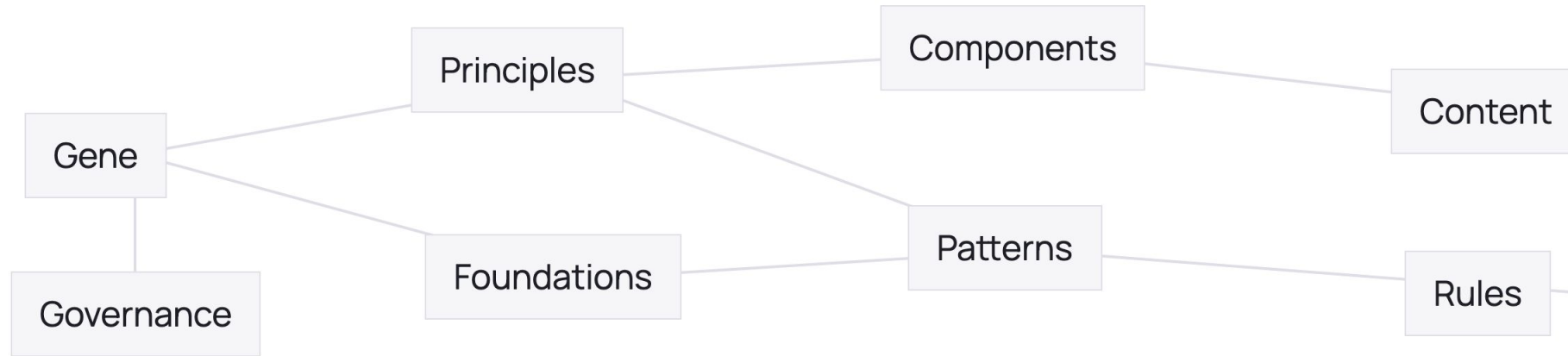
One decision worth inheriting.

One Gene.



Governance isn't making every decision automatic. It's making the boundary visible.

From Gene to Genome.



Illustrative connections, not a required topology.

You don't need to encode everything tomorrow.

Start with high-value decisions.

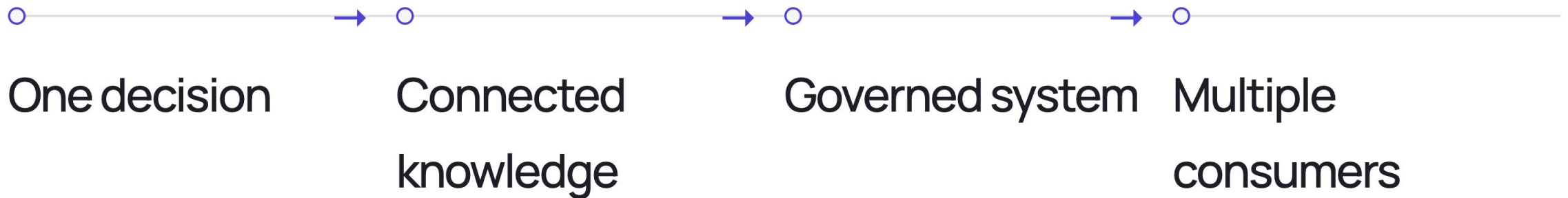
Make them consumable where useful.

Connect them.

Govern the boundaries.

The Genome can't carry forward knowledge your organization never put into it.

Now read the system through its decisions.



Design Genome is the methodology.
Forma is one implementation.

Start with one decision worth inheriting.

Give it intent.

Give it authority.

Connect it.

Govern it.

Let it travel.

The Design Genome

Your design intelligence
should outlive the tool
consuming it.

design-genome.com

[Framework](#) [Reference implementation](#) [Build your first Gene](#) [GitHub](#)

Ivan Barriga



design-genome.com